

### 4.1.1 Getting It Just So

One of the first things we recommend doing as soon as you start PowerPoint is to get the toolbar to show on two rows—click on the arrow on the far right of the toolbar and select **Show Buttons On Two Rows**. You might also want to drag the Drawing Toolbar from the bottom to the top, but that's a matter of preference.

The next item on hand is the way menus behave. PowerPoint's menus show you only the features you use most often; the rest of the menu shows up only if you wait long enough or if you click on the arrow at the bottom. This can get very annoying if you're exploring the program and want to see what it has to offer. To turn it off, go to **Tools > Customize**, and select **Always show full menus** under the Options tab.

Finally, you should enable the grid to help you arrange items in slides better. Go to **View > Grid and Guides** and choose **Display Grid on screen**; you can also specify the width of the grid. In PowerPoint 2007, you'll find this option under the View tab. In both versions, use **[Shift] + [F9]** to switch the grid on and off.

Now that we've got the preliminaries out of the way, let's get cracking on the presentation.

## 4.2 Working With Slides

When you start PowerPoint, you're faced with a blank slide, which PowerPoint rightly assumes to be the one you intend to start with. There's a text box for your title, and one for the subtitle (or the presenter's name, if necessary)—all quite straightforward. If you're not too keen on the positions of these boxes, you can move them around by clicking on their borders (the cursor turns into a 'move' crosshair) and dragging. Use the grid to get alignments right. You can also format the text you enter using the formatting tools in the toolbar.